Question ID: 4236c5a3

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Nonlinear equations in one variable and systems of equations in two variables	Easy

Question

If $(x+5)^2 = 4$, which of the following is a possible value of x ?

Answer

A. 1

B. -1

C. -2

D. -3

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. If $(x+5)^2 = 4$, then taking the square root of each side of the equation gives $x+5=2$ or $x+5=-2$. Solving these equations for x gives $x=-3$ or $x=-7$. Of these, -3 is the only solution given as a choice.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from solving the equation $x+5=4$ and making a sign error. Choice B is incorrect and may result from solving the equation $x+5=4$. Choice C is incorrect and may result from finding a possible value of $x+5$.